



PHP Arrays 25m

An array stores information for multiple values in a single variable. In PHP, the underlying implementation of an array is an ordered map that associates values with keys (like a variable name). Arrays as PHP code can still be indexed using traditional methods, but they remain an associative array internally. There are three types of arrays in PHP, and all three types are created using the `array()` function. The three types of array are:

- indexed array – an array with a numeric index
- associative array – an array with named keys
- multidimensional array – an array that contains more than one array.

The following example creates an **indexed array** named `$age`, which stores seven number values. You can use the PHP `echo` to print a text that contains one of the values in the array:

```
<?php

$age = array("20", "45", "72", "18", "64", "34", "30");

echo "I am " . $age[2] . " years old.";

?>
```

Output: I am 72 years old.

Because the indexes start from 0, the element with the index 2 will be 72. This means 72 will be displayed in our output.

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Associative arrays use both a key and a value. The following example creates an **associative array** named \$studentage, which has four stored named keys. You can use echo to print the text that contains one of these named keys from the array.

```
<?php

$studentage = array("Student1"=>"35", "Student2"=>"37",
"Student3"=>"43", "Student3"=>"25");

echo "Student 2 is " . $studentage['Student2'] . " years old.";

?>
```

Output: Student 2 is 37 years old.

This associative array has keys which are the 'student 1' and 'student 2' names used, which then have values assigned to them which are the ages of the students.



☒ Creating and accessing an array

Non-Assessed

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Use PHP to:

1. Create an array that contains the names of each month of the year (January–December)
2. Check the contents of the array are correct by using the very useful **var_dump** function. This is a great function for quick debugging.
3. Use the echo function to return the output of the month of October.

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Multidimensional arrays (2D arrays)

Two-dimensional arrays are created in much the same way as one-dimensional arrays, except that two index numbers are used. Conceptually, you can think of these as being like the rows and columns of a table (much like the grid layout of a spreadsheet). The first index is the row, and for a two-dimensional array, the second index is either column 0 or column 1. In this example, the first column holds the name of a month and the second column, the number of days in that month. For example:

Column 1	Column 2
January	31
February	28

The code below shows that a two-dimensional array has been created with two rows and two columns. Then echo has been used to print the text in the output by using the `$daysofmonth` array and pointing to the row and column indices.

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```
1 $daysofmonth = array (  
2   array("January",31),  
3   array("February",28)  
4 );  
5 echo $daysofmonth[0][0]." ".$daysofmonth[0][1]." ";  
6 echo $daysofmonth[1][0]." ".$daysofmonth[1][1]." ";
```



☒ Multidimensional array

Non-Assessed

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- Use PHP to create a two-dimensional array for the amount of stock available for each type of fruit, using the table below.

Column 1	Column 2
Pears	25
Apples	15
Bananas	40
Oranges	3

- Use PHP to access the elements of the fruit array you just created by pointing to the relevant row and column, so the output reads '[stock level] [fruit] in stock'. For example, your output for the first row should read '25 pears in stock'. Do this for all four rows.

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